

## Source Integration

- NCERT Class 9, Chapter 4: Food Security in India

## Core Factual & Conceptual Architecture

### 1. Concept and Dimensions of Food Security

- Three Dimensions: Food security requires availability (production, imports, government stocks), accessibility (food within reach of every person), and affordability (adequate income to buy safe, nutritious food).
- Theoretical Evolution: Expanded from simple physical availability to Amartya Sen's entitlement approach, incorporating market exchange, production, and state provisioning.

### 2. Vulnerability and Historical Context

- Bengal Famine of 1943: Claimed 3 million lives in Bengal, demonstrating that famines can occur due to failure of entitlements and access rather than absolute physical unavailability of food.
- Vulnerable Groups: Landless labourers, traditional artisans, casual urban workers, and socially disadvantaged groups (SCs, STs) face chronic insecurity.
- Seasonal Hunger: Tied to agricultural cycles for rural workers and employment fluctuations for urban casual labourers.

### 3. Pillar 1: Buffer Stock & FCI

- Procurement & MSP: The Food Corporation of India purchases surplus foodgrains from farmers at pre-announced Minimum Support Prices (MSP) to maintain buffer stocks for emergencies and public distribution.
- Criticisms: High carrying costs, rising procurement expenses, and storage inefficiencies resulting in grain spoilage despite persistent hunger.

### 4. Pillar 2: Public Distribution System (PDS)

- Fair Price Shops: Foodgrains and essential commodities are distributed via a network of regulated ration shops.
- Policy Evolution: Transitioned from universal PDS to Revamped PDS (1992), Targeted PDS (1997) with differential pricing, Antyodaya Anna Yojana (2000) for the poorest, and the National Food Security Act (2013).

### 5. Supplementary Programmes and Cooperatives

- Poverty Alleviation Links: Integrated Child Development Services (ICDS), Mid-Day Meal schemes, and employment programmes provide crucial nutritional safety nets.
- Cooperative Models: State cooperatives in Tamil Nadu, Mother Dairy in Delhi, Amul in Gujarat, and ADS Grain Banks in Maharashtra demonstrate successful decentralized food security management.